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Top Skills

Business Economics
General Legal Counsel
Corporate Strategy

Languages

Smalltalk
Technobabble
Perl
Ruby
Legalese
English
LISP

Certifications

Bar Member

Honors-Awards

Olin Prize for Law & Economics

Publications

Our First Real War
When Obama picks a new Supreme Court justice, older is better
Measuring the Influence of Supreme Court Justices
What's The Return On Investment For A Supreme Court Justice?
The Future of Big Computing: A Victory for Lilliputians

Monty Kosma

Founder & CEO at Chironic.AI / Partner at The Breeze Law Firm
Austin, Texas, United States

Summary

Physics # Neuroscience # AI # Advanced Computing # Antitrust # Strategy # Operations # Startups

I got to know Richard Feynman in the mid-1980s. He showed me that it was possible, so I created for myself a life of curiosity and wonder.

As Feynman said, "What I cannot create, I do not understand." I've devoted myself to creation as my primary mode of experiencing life. So I've created software systems, businesses, non-profits, markets, ecosystems, legal arguments, public policies - occasionally communities, or furniture. And I've devoted substantial time and energy to equipping and empowering creators - entrepreneurs, artists, and scientists - to bring their vision into reality.

Experience

Chironic AI
Founder & CEO
April 2026 - Present (5 months)
Austin, Texas, United States

Creating AI leverage for boutique law firms serving startups, investors, and other creators, enabling them to outcompete BigLaw on quality, speed, and service.

The Breeze Law Firm, PLLC
Partner
April 2026 - Present (5 months)
Washington, District of Columbia, United States

Law and economics of technology products and services: strategic partnerships, commercial agreements, IP licensing, government regulation and investigations, and litigation. Specialty areas include creative content (art, film, music, software), commercial speech, antitrust, and the evolving landscape of AI regulation.

R Street Institute

Director; Chairman of the Board

December 2024 - Present (1 year 9 months)

Washington, DC

Providing fiduciary oversight and strategic leadership for a leading free-market think tank, advancing pragmatic, data-driven policy that supports limited, effective government, competitive markets, and individual liberty. Elected Chairman in July 2025.

1517 Fund

Advisor

July 2022 - Present (4 years 2 months)

DataJoint

Co-Founder & President

May 2022 - September 2025 (3 years 5 months)

Austin, TX

Completed a 0->1 arc transforming DataJoint from an open-source consultancy into a successful product business:

- Won a \$3M SBIR grant from NIH
- Led creation and launch of a commercial DataOps platform for reproducible scientific computation
- Raised \$1M in angel investment
- Built relationships with flagship customers like JHU, UCSF, and Harvard, growing ARR to >\$500k
- With Harvard's Office of Technology Development and Harvard Medical School, developed and implemented a new approach to monetizing AI software and scientific data
- Developed GTM strategy, market segmentation, and sizing; crafted brand, core value prop, messaging, and product marketing
- Recruited a superstar CEO, collaborated on closing a \$4.8M equity round, and handed off for growth phase

Strategality llc

Founder & Principal

January 2008 - May 2023 (15 years 5 months)

San Francisco Bay Area

Consultant and advisor to early-stage technology companies, executives, and VC / PE funds. Representative projects include:

- for a major private equity fund, led a team analyzing competition and growth of a pre-IPO provider of tech-enabled services; validated an investment of ~ \$500M that has yielded cash distributions of over >\$300M in the first 5 years
- created a presentation for a Fortune 50 Board of Directors explaining cloud, SaaS, and financial impact of transitioning traditional hardware and software sales to recurring subscription revenues; coached division CEO and corporate development team on presenting to the Board
- developed government affairs org design and public policy/regulatory strategy for a manufacturer of LiDAR sensors
- evaluated products, technology, GTM strategy, partnerships, and executive leadership for a Board and investors in a company providing TCP/IP optimization technologies for wired, wireless, and IoT networks
- developed new mathematical models for analyzing edge interactions in social data networks
- advised on fundraising strategy and storyline for AI, NLP, data center equipment, CPG, peer-to-peer marketplace, and 3D scanning businesses

Angel investment in companies across numerous industries, such as in-home health monitoring services and platforms supporting DevOps and software engineering. See also <https://angel.co/montgomery-kosma>

Darcy Partners

Chief Technology Officer

July 2019 - December 2020 (1 year 6 months)

Greater Houston

Led digital transformation for Darcy Partners, a technology research company serving the energy industry. Designed, built, and grew a web and mobile platform serving clients in hundreds of top energy companies with research and events covering over 1,000 innovators and their technology products and services. During the pandemic, successfully pivoted the company from in-person to virtual events, enabling thousands of energy industry executives and engineers to collaborate with each other and to engage with technology providers.

Landover Wireless Corp

EVP Global Strategic Partnerships

November 2016 - September 2018 (1 year 11 months)

San Francisco, CA

- built partnerships with top tech and media companies on \$3B investment and B2B2C 5G telecom services

- developed acquisition strategy and analysis for a roll-up of broadcasters and spectrum assets covering >85% of US pops; synthesized market-by-market financial analysis and negotiation strategy with outputs from the telecom engineering team
- engaged leaders at FCC, FTC, White House Council of Economic Advisors, and US Senate to lay groundwork for regulatory approvals

Sovolve

Head of Product / Engineering

July 2014 - July 2016 (2 years 1 month)

Responsible for the product and engineering teams for Wonder, a sophisticated app that helps people capture and share their reputation by engaging their friends in evaluating their strengths. Led the design, build, launch, and iteration of a cross-platform system using ember.js and cordova for iOS and Android apps, powered by a Ruby on Rails back-end.

Sovolve's founders built and led Couchsurfing.com, and are backed by experts in social science, psychology and game theory. The company raised \$2MM from investors like Jonathan Teo (Binary/General Catalyst/Benchmark), Chris Kelly (CPO Facebook), Lloyd Carney (CEO Brocade), and Ed Ojdana (CEO FreeCreditReports.com).

Smart Tech Foundation

Co-Founder & Interim CEO

January 2013 - October 2013 (10 months)

Helped create an innovation economy to develop products and services to reduce gun violence as the founder and interim CEO of the Incentive Challenges Foundation (now Smart Tech Foundation), backed by Ron Conway and other Silicon Valley leaders. Established a partnership with teams from the X-Prize to conduct innovation competitions in areas like personalized firearms, community safety, and brain health.

Fandor

Chief Operating Officer & General Counsel

August 2010 - November 2012 (2 years 4 months)

San Francisco

I helped build Fandor, a "Netflix for Hipsters" that's now the leading online service for independent and world cinema. Fandor uses curation to attack the problem of discovery in long-tail markets, and employs a novel licensing

and revshare model to level the playing field for creators. Roger Ebert called Fandor “invaluable in finding great films.”

As COO, I directed all operations including finance, HR, legal, streaming delivery, content encoding, and marketing. I architected our corporate/ competitive strategy, prepared investor presentation materials, and coordinated strategic execution among product, content, and marketing teams. I managed an annual budget over \$5M, set P&L/growth targets, and developed financial plans, models, and forecasts. Developed, mentored, led, and coached team of six direct reports.

Under my leadership, we attained the #1 rank in the iTunes lifestyle category and among the top 15 free apps overall. I built and led a dedicated engineering team that architected and operated an attention- and curation-driven content licensing algorithm, as well as an AWS cloud infrastructure for video encoding and streaming delivery. We achieved 1,000% improvement in growth rate within five months, after I developed and led execution of an integrated growth strategy across product, content, and marketing organizations.

CPA Global

Vice President -- Legal Solutions

2009 - 2010 (1 year)

Led strategic sales initiatives for an internal startup division of \$1 billion outsourcing firm CPA Global. Developed and grew a new line of business offering non-traditional alternatives to expensive law firms.

MetaJure, Inc.

Director of Consulting Services

August 2008 - August 2009 (1 year 1 month)

Designed and led a change program for a multi-billion-dollar IP investment fund that improved portfolio risk, halved data management costs, and shifted behaviors towards cooperation and compliance.

McKinsey & Company

Management Consultant

April 2007 - August 2008 (1 year 5 months)

Management consultant in the Media, Private Equity, and Lean Operations practice groups.

Jones Day

Associate

September 2002 - April 2007 (4 years 8 months)

Antitrust attorney advising clients on economic and legal impact of business models, product design, marketing practices, and industry standard-setting in markets such as digital music, concert promotion, film distribution, tax software, local search, and CPG.

Lead counsel in copyright, fraud, and consumer protection cases before US trial and appellate courts, US Supreme Court, and FTC. Managed litigation valued over \$100MM and mergers valued over \$100BN. Reengineered legal operations to increase attorney productivity by 300% and improve decision quality by 10X.

The Green Bag

Co-Founder & Executive Editor

1997 - 2007 (10 years)

Grew The Green Bag into one of the nation's top 5 law journals. "While subscriptions to academic law journals are sagging ... Green Bag's are doubling every two years." R.K. Cooper, *Get Out of Your Own Way* 148 (2006); profiled in L.A. Times (2006) and on All Things Considered (2003)

Gibson Dunn & Crutcher

Associate

June 1996 - August 2002 (6 years 3 months)

Analyzed competition economics for investigations involving microprocessors, IMS database tools, EDA design software, cat food, and retail category management.

Working with Ted Olson, second-chaired a case that overturned FCC regulations permitting FBI to conduct warrantless surveillance of VOIP communications, and supervised the joint factual record preparation for the Supreme Court in *Bush v. Gore*.

U.S. Court of Appeals

Law Clerk to Judge David B. Sentelle

1997 - 1998 (1 year)

On the side, edited and published the bestselling memoir, *Judge Dave and the Rainbow People*.

Triple I

Design Team Leader

1992 - 1994 (2 years)

Led interaction design for a transformative sales operations application that client's President described as "the best \$900,000 the company has ever spent"; finalist in Windows World Open competition

PDA, Inc.

Systems Engineer

1991 - 1992 (1 year)

Managed project estimating and software development for secondary school administration suite

Delphi Systems, Ltd.

Chief Technology Officer

January 1990 - December 1991 (2 years)

Designed and developed methodology, algorithms, and a software application, Wingspread, to assess skills of knowledge workers, including advanced search algorithms to match employees with positions and analytics to evaluate commonalities among groups of employees

Conducted a pilot study profiling successful PepsiCo SVPs to identify characteristics of high-potential candidates for training and promotion

Lockheed Aeronautical Systems Co.

Scientist

July 1988 - August 1990 (2 years 2 months)

Pioneered use of Thinking Machines parallel processing supercomputers in support of stealth aircraft design by the Skunk Works; solved one of the largest computational problems in history (see NY Times, Nov. 25, 1990, § 1 at 1)

University of California, Irvine

Researcher

1987 - 1987 (less than a year)

In the psychobiology lab of Dr. Carl Cotman, developed protein-level computer models of synapse junctions to evaluate breakdown of the LTP memory mechanism, a potential root cause of Alzheimer's

Education

University of Chicago Law School

JD, Law · (1994 - 1997)

Harvey Mudd College

B.S., Physics · (1984 - 1988)

Landmark Education